

MANU BHAKER LOOKED LIKE A TRAILBLAZER, THEN BECAME ONE

Manu is a true wunderkind, but her rise to becoming **India's most prolific shooter** wasn't just talent — it was grit, fire, and an unyielding will to conquer every obstacle.

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WATCH MANU'S
INTERVIEW

The first edition of the reinstated Sportstar Aces Awards, held on February 15, 2019, witnessed an unfiltered yet endearing moment when Manu Bhaker, then a prodigious talent, stepped onto the stage.

Fresh from the rigours of a day-long training session and a four-hour journey, Manu found herself at a rare loss for words. Named Young Athlete of the Year (girl), she could only manage a sheepish smile and the words, "I don't know what to say. I didn't even change my clothes or go to the washroom."

The sincerity of the 16-year-old pistol shooter's confession not only drew ripples of laughter across the ceremony hall but also instantly endeared her to all present.

Fast forward nearly six years, and Manu's life remains as hectic as ever. Coincidentally, she finds herself at the same hotel in Mumbai, attending the same function.

Once again, she arrived directly from the Dr. Karni Singh Shooting Range in New Delhi. This time, however, she manages to squeeze in 10 minutes to freshen up before her name is called out — twice.

First, International Cricket Council chairman Jay Shah presents her with the Sportstar of the Year (Female) award, followed by the Sportswoman of the Year (Olympic Sports) honour.

"I thought I might get one award,